

prioritizing those that offer both profitability and sustainability. Guiding our expansion efforts is Legacy Iron Ore Limited, our subsidiary possessing exploration rights for various minerals including iron ore, gold, nickel, base metals, and tungsten in the mining powerhouse – Australia.

Also, through International Coal Ventures Limited (ICVL), a joint venture comprising SAIL, RINL, and NMDC, we acquired a coking/thermal coal mine in Mozambique, South Africa in 2014. NMDC maintains a 26% stake in ICVL. In FY23, the Benga mine, an operational asset under ICVL, yielded about 1.63 million tonnes of coal with exports totaling 1.71 million tonnes contributed to the global resource markets.

Q What are the community engagements that you do at the sites where NMDC operates?

NMDC operates in deep hamlets of Chhattisgarh and Karnataka and is committed to enhance the quality of life for the people living around its mines. Since the early 1960's, NMDC brought hospitals, schools, and employment opportunities to these remote locations, winning the company its social license.

Towards empowering the underserved communities, NMDC has rolled out transformational social initiatives focusing on five core areas - quality education for all, upskilling opportunities, robust healthcare, infrastructure development and safe drinking water.

We take most pride in supporting the journeys of tribal youth of the country. Over thousand students from NMDC's Industrial Training Institutes are employed at multinational companies. Our flagship CSR initiative, Balika Shiksha Yojana has sponsored the nursing education of over 500 tribal girls in the last decade and strengthened the healthcare workforce in the State. The residential schools, Saksham for specially-abled students and Aastha Gurukul for children who have lost their parents due to violence in the region, embody the true spirit of education for all. NMDC's social initiatives are driven



by the purpose to create a vibrant environment that is brimming with opportunities and value for the community living around its mines.

Q Once a mine is depleted, how do you ensure that the community and environment in its vicinity is not impacted and fosters sustainability existence?

Devoted to achieve the right balance between tapping our mineral potential and conserving our forests, NMDC has built a sturdy afforestation programme to restore the forests affected by mining. We have planted over 3 million trees in and around our projects in Chhattisgarh, Karnataka and Madhya Pradesh since the start of our mining operations. We actively support and contribute to 'Chhattisgarh Harihar Tree Plantation Programme', the flagship afforestation initiative of the State that is creating a long-term carbon-sink.

NMDC conducts annual Carbon Footprint studies to evaluate the Greenhouse Gas emissions from our operations and in the last decade, we have reduced our total per tonne GHG emission intensity by 24%.

Working towards 'Zero-Waste Mining', we are finding ways to utilize various grades of iron ore. To this end, NMDC has set up a Beneficiation and Pellet Plant in Donimalai and a similar plant on a larger scale is

underway in Bailadila. Our sustainability strategy focuses on the areas that represent key opportunities in reducing our Carbon Footprint i.e. Scientific Mining, Biodiversity Conservation, and Energy Efficiency.

Q India is surging ahead as a global economy to join the elite club of top three economies of the world by 2032.

How do you see NMDC as a strong force in the country's ambitious endeavours?

NMDC stands out for its extensive reservoirs of high-quality iron ore, mining expertise spanning over six generations, and solid financial footing. Our partnership with the Steel Industry has been the cornerstone of India's industrial progress.

As our nation forays towards becoming an economic superpower, NMDC is gearing up to play a defining role in the country's journey to Atmanirbhar Steel. In line with the vision of the National Steel Policy, we will ramp up our mining capacity to 100 million tonnes towards achieving the national steelmaking capacity of 300 MTPA by 2030.

In realizing our vision to emerge as a global mining company, one that only meets the needs of the present but also safeguards the needs of the future generations, NMDC will be a mighty force in shaping an Indian economy that is strong, resilient and sustainable.

